

NEXACORE TECHNOLOGIES INC.

Employee Handbook & HR Policy Manual

Version 4.2 | Effective Date: January 1, 2025 | Confidential — Internal Use Only

1. WELCOME & COMPANY OVERVIEW

Welcome to NexaCore Technologies. This handbook outlines your rights, responsibilities, and the policies that govern our workplace. All employees are expected to read, understand, and comply with these policies. This document supersedes all previous versions. For questions, contact HR at hr@nexacore.com or ext. 1000.

2. EMPLOYMENT CATEGORIES

Full-Time Employees: Scheduled to work 40 hours per week. Eligible for all benefits including health insurance, 401(k), PTO, and bonuses.

Part-Time Employees: Scheduled fewer than 30 hours per week. Eligible for prorated PTO only.

Contract/Temporary: Employed for a fixed term or project. Not eligible for standard benefits unless specified in contract.

Probationary Period: All new hires serve a 90-day probationary period. Performance is reviewed at 30, 60, and 90 days.

3. WORKING HOURS & ATTENDANCE

Standard business hours are Monday through Friday, 9:00 AM to 6:00 PM local time. Core hours where all team members must be available are 10:00 AM to 4:00 PM. Flexible start/end times may be arranged with manager approval.

Remote Work Policy: Employees may work remotely up to 3 days per week subject to role eligibility and manager approval. Full-time remote arrangements require VP-level sign-off and a signed Remote Work Agreement.

Overtime: Non-exempt employees receive 1.5x pay for hours worked beyond 40 per week. All overtime must be pre-approved by department head. Unauthorized overtime will not be compensated.

4. LEAVE POLICIES

Annual Leave (PTO):

Years of Service	Annual PTO Days	Rollover Limit	Payout on Exit
0 – 1 year	15 days	5 days	Accrued balance paid
1 – 3 years	18 days	7 days	Accrued balance paid
3 – 5 years	22 days	10 days	Accrued balance paid
5 – 10 years	25 days	12 days	Accrued balance paid

10+ years	28 days	15 days	Accrued balance paid
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Sick Leave: 10 days per calendar year. Does not roll over. Requires medical certificate for absences exceeding 3 consecutive days.

Maternity Leave: 16 weeks fully paid, extendable to 24 weeks at 60% pay. Applicable to birth parents.
Adoption leave: 12 weeks fully paid.

Paternity Leave: 4 weeks fully paid within 6 months of child's birth or adoption.

Bereavement Leave: 5 days for immediate family (spouse, child, parent, sibling); 3 days for extended family (grandparents, in-laws); 1 day for close friends.

Jury Duty: Full pay for up to 15 business days. Provide court summons to HR within 48 hours of receipt.

Unpaid Leave of Absence: May be granted for up to 6 months for qualifying personal reasons. Benefits continue at employee's expense (COBRA). Role may not be held beyond 3 months.

5. COMPENSATION & PAYROLL

Salaries are paid bi-weekly (every two weeks) via direct deposit. Pay periods close on Fridays; payroll is disbursed the following Friday.

Salary Reviews: Conducted annually in January. Merit increases are based on performance rating and market benchmarking. Average increase for FY2025 is budgeted at 4.5%.

Bonus Structure: Annual performance bonus paid in February for the prior calendar year. Target bonus by level:

Level	Title Examples	Target Bonus
IC1-IC2	Associate, Analyst	5% of base salary
IC3-IC4	Senior, Lead	10% of base salary
M1-M2	Manager, Senior Manager	15% of base salary
D1-D2	Director, Senior Director	20% of base salary
VP+	VP, SVP, C-Suite	25-40% of base salary

6. PERFORMANCE MANAGEMENT

NexaCore uses a continuous performance management model with formal reviews twice per year (June and December).

Rating Scale:

5 – Exceptional: Consistently exceeds all goals; role model for the company. Top 5%.

4 – Exceeds Expectations: Exceeds most goals; significant contributions. Top 20%.

3 – Meets Expectations: Meets all core goals; solid performer.

2 – Needs Improvement: Partially meets goals; improvement plan required within 30 days.

1 – Unsatisfactory: Fails to meet critical goals; immediate performance improvement plan (PIP) issued.

PIP Process: A Performance Improvement Plan is a formal 60-day plan with weekly check-ins. If performance does not improve to a '3' rating within the PIP period, termination may result.

7. CODE OF CONDUCT

All employees must maintain the highest standards of professional conduct. This includes:

- Treating all colleagues, clients, and partners with respect regardless of role, background, or identity
- Maintaining confidentiality of proprietary and client information at all times
- Avoiding conflicts of interest; disclosing any outside employment or financial interests
- Zero tolerance for harassment, discrimination, or retaliation of any kind
- Reporting suspected misconduct via the anonymous Ethics Hotline: 1-800-NEXAETH
- Complying with all applicable laws, regulations, and company policies
- No use of company resources (computers, email, phones) for personal gain or inappropriate content

8. BENEFITS SUMMARY

Health Insurance: Medical (Blue Cross PPO/HMO), Dental, Vision. Company pays 80% of premium for employee; 50% for dependents. Open enrollment in November each year.

401(k) Retirement Plan: Company matches 100% of first 4% of salary contributed, plus 50% of next 2%. Vesting schedule: 25% per year, fully vested at 4 years.

Life Insurance: 2x annual salary, company-paid. Supplemental coverage available at employee's expense.

Employee Assistance Program (EAP): Free confidential counseling (up to 8 sessions/year), financial planning, legal advice, and wellness resources.

Learning & Development: \$2,500 annual education reimbursement for job-related courses, certifications, or conferences. Requires manager approval and minimum 'Meets Expectations' rating.

Commuter Benefits: Pre-tax commuter cards up to \$315/month (IRS 2025 limit) for transit and parking.

9. FREQUENTLY ASKED HR QUESTIONS

Q: How do I request annual leave?

A: Submit a leave request in the Workday HR portal at least 5 business days in advance for leave up to 5 days, and 15 business days for leave exceeding 5 days. Your manager will approve or decline within 3 business days.

Q: What happens to my unused PTO at year-end?

A: PTO rolls over up to your rollover limit (see Section 4). Any balance above the rollover limit is forfeited on December 31st. There is no cash payout for forfeited PTO.

Q: How do I check my remaining PTO balance?

A: Log into Workday > Time Off > Balance Summary. Balances update in real-time after each payroll cycle.

Q: When is my salary review?

A: Annual salary reviews occur in January. Your manager will schedule a review meeting in December to discuss performance ratings, which determine merit increases effective February 1st.

Q: How do I apply for a role internally?

A: Internal job postings are live for 7 days before external posting. Apply via the Careers page on the intranet using your employee login. You must have been in your current role for at least 12 months and hold a rating of 3 or above.

Q: What is the process for reporting harassment?

A: Report to your HR Business Partner, your manager's manager, or use the anonymous Ethics Hotline (1-800-NEXAETH). All reports are investigated within 5 business days. Retaliation against reporters is strictly prohibited.

Q: Can I work from another country?

A: Short-term remote work abroad (up to 30 days per year) may be permitted with manager and HR approval. Long-term international arrangements require legal and tax review and are generally not approved unless on a formal international assignment.

Q: How do I update my emergency contacts or beneficiaries?

A: Log into Workday > Personal > Emergency Contacts or Benefits > Beneficiaries. Updates take effect immediately.

Q: What is the notice period for resignation?

A: IC1-IC4: 2 weeks. M1-M2: 4 weeks. Director+: 6 weeks. Please submit written notice to your manager and HR simultaneously.

Q: Am I eligible for a referral bonus?

A: Yes. Employee referrals that result in a hire and 90-day retention earn a \$2,000 bonus (IC roles) or \$3,500 (M1+). Referral bonus is paid in the next payroll after the 90-day mark.

For additional questions not covered here, contact your HR Business Partner or email hr@nexacore.com